

Photography Proposal

Prepared for our photographer — creative direction and shot list for the new CLA City website.

The Project

We're rebuilding the CLA City website with a calmer, more premium visual identity — think modern, trustworthy, Apple-level simplicity, still warm and unmistakably a church home. Photography carries most of that feeling, so this shoot isn't about replacing what we have (we already have a large photo library) — it's about filling specific gaps for new sections of the site.

Visual Direction

- **Light:** natural, soft daylight wherever possible. Avoid harsh on-camera flash.
- **Color:** true-to-life, neutral grading — not heavy amber/warm filters, not oversaturated. Our site palette is a deep navy/royal blue with warm ivory and a soft gold accent, so images should sit comfortably next to that, not fight it.
- **Composition:** candid over posed. Real interaction and genuine expression beat a lineup smiling at the camera.
- **Negative space:** for a few hero-style shots, leave open, uncluttered space (sky, wall, soft blur) on one side — we place text over these images.
- **Consistency:** one cohesive editing style across the set, so new photos read as part of the same library as our existing ones.

Priority Shot List

These are tied directly to new features going into the site — please prioritize in this order if time is limited.

1. Pastor welcome portrait

Leonid & Marina together, candid and warm — not a formal stage photo. Used next to a personal welcome note on the homepage, so it should feel like an invitation, not a title card.

2. Front-door welcome moment

Someone being greeted at the entrance / first handshake or hug. For a new "New Here?" page aimed at first-time visitors.

3. Livestream / tech booth

Camera operator, streaming setup, or a wide shot showing the service being filmed. For a new "Watch Live" call-to-action.

4. Volunteers actually serving

Hospitality, parking, ushers, or tech team mid-task — not posed. For a new Volunteer/Serve section.

5. Quiet devotional moments

Hands on an open Bible, a journal, a quiet prayer close-up, natural light. For a new short-form Bible blog section — these should feel intimate and still, not staged.

6. Russian-language service, candid congregation

Genuine engagement during the Russian-language service specifically — supports a homepage panel explaining what that service is like.

7. Wide sanctuary establishing shot with open space

A flexible wide shot with room for text overlay, for hero banner options across pages.

Technical Notes

- Mix of orientations: wide/landscape for full-width hero banners, and portrait (roughly 4:5) for cards.
- Deliver high-resolution originals with minimal or no filter presets applied — final color grading happens on our end to match the site.
- A few "quiet" frames without people are useful for flexible text-overlay backgrounds.

Next Step

We'd love to schedule a shoot day around a Sunday service plus a short weekday session for portraits (pastors, volunteers). Happy to walk through this list together and adjust based on what's realistic for the day.